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<https://russelldudek.github.io/MDC/>

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Michael DiPerna and Hiring Team

MDC Executive Search

Re: Chief Operating Officer - AI Adoption

Michael and Hiring Team,

The role description makes the operating problem unusually clear: the founder should remain in the market, while the company beneath that market energy becomes predictable, profitable, client-retentive, and increasingly AI-enabled. That is not a ceremonial COO seat. It is the work of turning every client promise into a load-bearing operating system.

My career has repeatedly lived at that boundary. At Vape-Jet, I lead an AI-first operating transformation connecting production, purchasing, quality, customer support, engineering issue flow, ERP, CRM, collaboration systems, telemetry, and learning from a fleet of roughly 1,000 fielded robots. At DudeWorth, I build practical agentic-workflow frameworks connecting context, retrieval, human judgment, evaluation, escalation, governance, adoption, and value. At Amazon, I ran high-velocity mechanisms protecting a time-bound customer promise at 24/7 scale. At Compunetics, I connected engineering, manufacturing, quality, customers, and technical programs where errors carried real consequences.

The common thread is mechanism building: establish one operating truth, name owners, expose drift early, make escalation useful, and turn experience into a stronger next cycle. In this role, I would apply that discipline to the full engagement system - sales handoff, scope, utilization, staffing, human-and-agent capacity, delivery control, outcome evidence, renewal, margin, billing, and cash.

I would begin by instrumenting before redesigning. The first 30 days should reveal which numbers the team trusts, where founder involvement is strategic versus compensating for a missing mechanism, how proposal assumptions change in delivery, and which client evidence actually predicts renewal. Days 31-90 would install the shared engagement record, scope-change thresholds, forecast reconciliation, pipeline-weighted capacity plan, and written remote onboarding system. By day 120, recurring operations should run beneath the founder with only named exceptions returning for attention.

The direct professional-services P&L mechanics of the confidential firm would need to be learned quickly and specifically. What transfers immediately is a verified record of building operating cadence, quality and escalation systems, distributed execution, customer-centered mechanisms, technical translation, AI-enabled workflows, and cross-system accountability. That combination is the reason I believe I can contribute at the level this role demands.

I created a role-specific candidate vision at <https://russelldudek.github.io/MDC/>. It makes my reasoning visible through an interactive Engagement Load Path, a first-year scorecard, a 120-day entry plan, and a proposed Founder Operating Contract. These are hypotheses for discovery, not claims about the confidential client's undisclosed processes.

I would welcome a conversation about where founder attention is still carrying work the company should carry, which engagement evidence most reliably predicts renewal, and how the firm currently manages AI agents as accountable capacity rather than convenient software.

Carpe diem,

Russell Dudek